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Reporting guidance for use levels on food additives and food flavourings - 2026

Data model elements

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Abstract

This document should be used for the reporting to EFSA of the use levels of food additives and food flavourings in product categories/foods. It provides guidance on how to use the data model and gives information on the different data elements and business rules. It also provides guidance on the preparation, submission, validation and acceptance of the data.

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Table of contents

Abstract	1
Table of contents	3
1 Introduction	4
1.1 Background	4
2 Data elements	6
2.1 Programme legal reference (progLegalRef) (mandatory)	6
2.2 Product identification code (prodId) (mandatory)	6
2.3 Reporting country (repCountry) (optional).....	6
2.4 Marketing country (marketCountry) (mandatory).....	6
2.5 Marketing year (marketYear), Marketing month (marketMonth) and Marketing day (marketDay) (mandatory).....	7
2.6 Reporting year (repYear) (mandatory).....	7
2.7 Coded description of the matrix (matCode) (mandatory).....	7
2.8 Textual description of the matrix (matText) (optional)	10
2.9 Restriction or exception (restrictionException) (mandatory).....	10
2.10 Brand name (brandName) (optional).....	11
2.11 Manufacturer name (manufacturer) (optional)	11
2.12 Manufacturer type (foodIndustry) (mandatory).....	11
2.13 Parameter code (paramCode) (mandatory)	11
2.14 Parameter text (paramText) (optional)	12
2.15 Record identification code (recId) (mandatory)	12
2.16 Widely consumed product (widelyConsumed) (optional).....	12
2.17 Presence/Added (presenceAdded) (mandatory)	12
2.18 Function of the substance (functionOf) (dependent mandatory)	14
2.19 Expression of product (weight) (mandatory).....	14
2.20 Percentage of fat (fatPerc) (dependent mandatory)	14
2.21 Percentage of moisture (moistPerc) (dependent mandatory)	15
2.22 Result unit (unit) (mandatory)	15
2.23 Additional information (additionalInfo) (optional)	15
2.24 Minimum use level (minLevel) (optional).....	15
2.25 Typical use level (typicalLevel) (mandatory)	15
2.26 Maximum use level (maxLevel) (mandatory)	15
2.27 Conversion or dilution factor (conversionOrDilutionFactor) (dependent mandatory).....	16
2.28 Is maximum permitted level defined (maxPermittedLevelDefined) (mandatory) ..	16
2.29 Maximum permitted level (maxPermittedLevel) (dependent mandatory)	16
3 Methodologies	17
4 Legal Limit Database	18
References	29
Abbreviations.....	30



1 Introduction

1.1 Background

Regulation (EC) No 1333/2008¹ and Regulation (EC) No 1334/2008² lay down rules on food additives (FA) and food flavourings (FF) used in foods with a view to ensure the effective functioning of the internal market whilst ensuring a high level of protection of human health. These regulations aim to protect consumer interests and fair practices in food trade, protecting the environment where feasible, also providing a list of FA/FF and source materials approved for use in and on foods, conditions of use of such substances and rules on the labelling of FA/FF sold as such.

The objective of the monitoring of the consumption and the use of FA/FF is to gather data on their intake and to assess that their use does not raise a health concern. This monitoring helps in verifying the dietary intakes estimated at the time of establishment of the authorisation or re-evaluation. The monitoring is also a relevant information source for future risk management measures. Finally, the data collected during the monitoring could be used for future risk assessment purposes, e.g., to assess the combined exposure to multiple chemicals. To achieve this objective, a common terminology and methodology need to be implemented.

For such purpose, European Commission requested to EFSA to open a yearly data collection on FA/FF ([M-2022-00210](#)), starting with a pilot in 2025, followed by a second pilot in 2026.

Following the Commission Recommendation (EU) 2023/965³ on the methodology for the monitoring of FA/FF intake, MS should collect at least one of the following types of data:

- (a) Analytical data: concentration of FA/FF measured in food.
- (b) Use levels: concentration of FA/FF reported by business operators to be added to food.

MS may also collect (c) presence data, i.e., data on the presence or the absence of a specific FA/FF in a foodstuff. Since the collected data should allow for the calculation of the FA/FF intake, the collection of presence data alone is not sufficient, and MS should collect at least one type of occurrence data (analytical data or use levels). However, it is recommended to also collect presence data to identify whether a FA/FF is used or not used in a particular foodstuff.

While analytical data on FA/FF should be submitted to EFSA using the SSD2 (Standard Sample Description version 2) format (EFSA, 2025a), EFSA developed the new data model

¹ Regulation (EC) No 1333/2008 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 16 December 2008 on food additives; document available at <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/PDF/?uri=CELEX:32008R1333>

² Regulation (EC) No 1334/2008 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 16 December 2008 on flavourings and certain food ingredients with flavouring properties for use in and on foods and amending Council Regulation (EEC) No 1601/91, Regulations (EC) No 2232/96 and (EC) No 110/2008 and Directive 2000/13/EC; document available at <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/LexUriServ/LexUriServ.do?uri=OJ:L:2008:354:0034:0050:en:PDF>

³ Commission Recommendation (EU) 2023/965 of 12 May 2023 on the methodology for the monitoring of food additive and food flavouring intake. OJEU L 129, 16 May 2023 p. 17



(DM) for the collection of use levels of FA/FF (EFSA, 2025b) and the present guidance contains the data model version that has been improved based on the first pilot. Together with the use levels, presence data can be collected with this model.

The use levels DM could be used by any stakeholder collecting use levels, such as industry data providers (DP) and MS compiling such data from several industrial members.

The use levels DM has been already piloted in 2025, and it will be piloted in 2026. The piloting involved three FA and two FF for 2025 and is going to involve two FA and three FF for 2026⁴. The result of the pilot 2025 has been assessed and considered to further adjust and improve the DM described in the present document.

Stakeholders will be given the possibility to transmit eXtensible Markup Language (XML) data files through the EFSA Data Collection Framework (DCF). The present DM is in accordance with the harmonised terminology of EFSA and, where applicable, with the terminology used in the EFSA Standard Sample Description (SSD2) of the annual Chemical Monitoring (ChemMon) data collection.

The current use levels DM is not implemented in SSD2. The current DM collects data of food categories and the FA/FF use level in those categories while SSD2 has been devised to host sample-based data collections. A detailed description of the data elements required by this DM and of the related set of Business Rules (BR) applied for data validation is reported in the last sections of the current document.

⁴ Pilot 2025: green S (E 142), tartrazine (E 102), ponceau 4R/cochineal red A (E 124), caffeine (16.016), pulegone (Annex III)
Pilot 2026: butylated hydroxytoluene (BHT) (E 321), sorbic acid – sorbates (E 200 – 203), coumarin (Annex III), hydrocyanic acid (Annex III), theobromine (16.032)

2 Data elements

The focus of this section is on the data elements required for the preparation of monitoring reports as well as those needed for dietary exposure assessments. The DM used by EFSA in the past to collect use levels and based on SSD1 data elements has been translated to SSD2 and, therefore, the current DM is SSD2-derived.

At the end of the present guidance, Table 1 provides the full list of the SSD2-derived data elements along with their applicability and the concerned controlled terminology (catalogues).

2.1 Programme legal reference (progLegalRef) (mandatory)

This data element is used to specify the legal framework under which the sampling is planned. The codes are linked to the catalogue LEGREF and must be selected from the 'faff' hierarchy. The only applicable codes are:

- N112A – Regulation (EC) No 1333/2008¹ of the European Parliament and of the Council of 16 December 2008 on food additives;
- N113A - Regulation (EC) No 1334/2008² of the European Parliament and of the Council of 16 December 2008 on flavourings and certain food ingredients with flavouring properties for use in and on foods.

Example	XML
Additive domain	<progLegalRef>N112A</ progLegalRef >

2.2 Product identification code (prodId) (mandatory)

Each product category/food must be identified by a unique code. The unique identification code cannot exceed 100 characters, and special characters must be avoided. Where multiple records are reported for a product category/food (e.g., records for different substances), the same product identification code must be reported.

Example	XML
Unique identifier for a category from 2026 in Italy	<prodId>IT_2026_mozzarella</prodId>

2.3 Reporting country (repCountry) (optional)

This data element contains information on the country reporting the data. If not present, this data element will be automatically populated by EFSA with the country of the reporting organization. Codes can be found in the COUNTRY catalogue.

2.4 Marketing country (marketCountry) (mandatory)

Through this data element needs to be reported relevant country codes in which the product category is marketed. Codes can be found in the COUNTRY catalogue. For example, if the product is available in the Scandinavian region, all the relevant Scandinavian countries shall be reported by using their ISO 3166-1-alpha-2 country codes

dollar sign ('\$') separated. More than one marketing country can be envisaged when industry is directly reporting the use level/presence data.

Example	XML
Product marketed in Spain and Italy	<code><marketCountry>ES\$IT</ marketCountry ></code>

2.5 Marketing year (marketYear), Marketing month (marketMonth) and Marketing day (marketDay) (mandatory)

The complete date on when the product/food was marketed is mandatory. The information on the marketing date is required to check the product/food compliance against the legal limit database (LLDB) applicable at the time of marketing.

Example	XML
Monday 5 October 2015	<code><marketYear>2015</marketYear></code> <code><marketMonth>10</marketMonth></code> <code><marketDay>05</marketDay></code>

2.6 Reporting year (repYear) (mandatory)

This data element is used to provide the reporting year, which must be equal to the current year of the data collection, e.g., during the 2026 data collection, the reporting year must be 2026.

Example	XML
2026 Pilot data collection	<code><repYear>2026</repYear></code>

2.7 Coded description of the matrix (matCode) (mandatory)

This data element should be used to describe the product category/food for which FA/FF aggregated values (use levels and/or presence data) are reported. Samples in FoodEx2 must be encoded according to the guidance for the harmonised use of the FoodEx2 system and the quality control of the codes (EFSA, 2015). To describe the product category/food reported, the code reflecting the highest level of detail is normally used. FoodEx2 codes can be selected from the MTX catalogue using the reporting hierarchy.

FoodEx2 requires that a base term is always supplied. If the implicit facets are enough to characterise the product category/food, only the base term needs to be reported.

This mandatory data element is also used to report the food legislative category of the reported product according to version 7 of Part E of Annex II to Regulation (EC) No 1333/2008⁵. To do so, one facet must always be present: the food legislative category (facet F33). F33 must be reported for both domains, additives and flavourings. In most of the cases, facet F33 is already pre-assigned in the codes present in the reporting hierarchy

⁵ Guidance document describing the food categories in Part E of Annex II to Regulation (EC) No 1333/2008 on Food Additives (version 7): https://food.ec.europa.eu/system/files/2022-12/fs_food-improvement-agents_guidance_1333-2008_annex-2.pdf



as implicit facets. If the F33 facet is not implicitly assigned, it is up to the DP to explicitly assign it. The legislative category “All categories of foods” is not allowed to be reported.

This data element is also used to indicate the physical state of the reported product such as granules, tablets, liquid, powder, etc. This information must be reported using the facet 03 (F03) – physical state. In some cases, the F03 facet is already pre-assigned as implicit facet to the FoodEx2 base terms; if the F03 is not implicitly assigned, it is up to the DP to explicitly assign it for the following food legislative categories:

- 01.5 Dehydrated milk as defined by Directive 2001/114/EC
- 01.6 Cream and cream powder
- 01.8 Dairy analogues, including beverage whiteners
- 01.9 Edible caseinates
- 01.10 Milk-based drinks and similar products intended for young children
- 06.3 Breakfast cereals
- 12.5 Soups and broths
- 12.6 Sauces
- 13 Foods intended for specific groups as defined by Regulation (EU) No 609/2013
- 14.1.2 Fruit juices as defined by Directive 2001/112/EC and vegetable juices
- 14.1.3 Fruit nectars as defined by Directive 2001/112/EC and vegetable nectars and similar products
- 14.1.4 Flavoured drinks
- 14.1.5 Coffee, coffee and chicory extracts, tea, herbal- and fruit-infusions; coffee substitutes, coffee mixes and mixes for ‘hot beverages’
- 17. Food supplements as defined in Directive 2002/46/EC of the European Parliament and of the Council excluding food supplements for infants and young children

Moreover, if the product category/food is formulated for infants (<12 months), belonging to the food category ‘13. Foods intended for particular nutritional uses as defined by Directive 2009/39/EC’, the target-consumer facet (F23) should be added to the code, specifying this information.



In cases where suitable codes to describe the item sampled cannot be found, it is recommended to ask EFSA for support for the addition of codes.

Example of matCode reported	Implicit and explicit facets code in the reported matCode	Note
Base term selected: A03QH = 'Infant formula, milk and soya-based, liquid' Correct code: A03QH	Implicit facets: F02: Part-nature = 'Infant formulae (as part-nature)' F03: Physical-state = 'Liquid' F04: Ingredient = 'Milk' F04: Ingredient = 'Soya proteins' F23: Target-consumer = 'Infant or toddler food' F33: Legislative-classes = 'FA-13.1.1 Infant formulae as defined by Commission Directive 2006/141/EC (1)'	
Base term selected: A03MX = 'Wine, red' Correct code: A03MX	Implicit facets: F02: Part-nature = 'Wine (as part-nature)' F10: Qualitative-Info = 'Red' F27: Source-Commodities = 'Wine grapes' F28: Process = 'Winemaking' F33: Legislative classes = 'FA-14.2.2 Wine and other products defined by Regulation (EEC) No 1234/2007, and alcohol-free counterparts'	
Base term selected: A02RH = 'Soft-ripened cheese' Correct code: A02RH	Implicit facets: F02: Part-nature = 'Ripened cheese (as part-nature)' F10: Qualitative-Info = 'Soft' F27: Source-Commodities = 'Milk' F28: Process = 'Cheesemaking' F28: Process = 'Ripening' F33: Legislative classes = 'FA-01.7.2 Ripened cheese'	
Base term selected: A03YN = 'Omelette, plain' Correct code: A03YN#F33.A0C33	Implicit facets: F02: Part-nature = 'Egg based dishes (as part-nature)' F04: Ingredient = 'Whole eggs' Explicit facets: F33: Legislative classes = 'FA- 10.2 Processed eggs and egg products'	Correct coding: based on the explicit F33 facet code added to the base term A03YN this product will be classified in the food additive legislative category 10.2.
Base term selected: A04KK = 'Teas leaves, dry and/or fermented, and similar' Correct code: A04KK#F03.A0CEA	Implicit facets: F02: Part-nature = 'Derivatives of coffee, cocoa, tea and similar RPCs (as part-nature)' F27: Source-Commodities = 'Camellia sinensis (tea) leaves' F28: Process = 'Drying (dehydration)' F33: Legislative-classes = '14.1.5.2 Other' Explicit facets: F03: Physical-state = 'Solid'	Correct coding: based on the explicit F03 facet code added to the base term A04KK this product will be identified as solid.
Base term selected: A03SL = 'Vitamin only supplements' Correct code: A03SL#F03.A1B1Y\$F33.A0C15	Implicit facets: F02: Part-nature = 'Food supplements and similar preparations (as part-nature)' F04: Ingredient = 'Vitamins' Explicit facets: F03: Physical-state = 'Syrup-type'	Correct coding: based on the explicit F03 and F33 facet codes added to the base term A03SL this product will be identified as syrup-



Example of matCode reported	Implicit and explicit facets code in the reported matCode	Note
	F33: Legislative-classes = 'FA-17.2 Food supplements supplied in a liquid form, excluding food supplements for infants and young children'	type and classified in the food additive legislative category 17.2.

2.8 Textual description of the matrix (matText) (optional)

After describing the product category/food with the most detailed level of information available using FoodEx2, the matText field can be used to report a full textual description of the product and to provide additional relevant information. This will provide a possibility of crosschecking for the codes reported and could highlight any data quality problem at data analysis level.

By default, if left empty, the data element is going to be populated with the text associated to the matCode selected.

2.9 Restriction or exception (restrictionException) (mandatory)

This mandatory data element should be used to provide the restrictions/exceptions as described in the Regulation (EC) No 1333/2008¹ for each authorised FA across the different food legislative categories. This data element can also be used for FF in the case Regulation (EC) No 1334/2008² describes restrictions/exceptions for their use.

The codes are linked to the catalogue ADDFOOD and should be selected from the specific hierarchy: 'FARestExc' for FA and 'FFRestExc' for FF. The most detailed category that defines the restriction/exception with the corresponding code should be chosen and reported in this data element.

Few examples are described below:

- If mozzarella cheese is the product for which the lactic acid use levels are going to be reported, then the restriction would be 'only mozzarella' of the category '01.7.1 Unripened cheese excluding products falling in category 16'.
- If milk chocolate is the product for which the citric acid use levels are going to be reported, the restriction would be 'only milk chocolate' falling in category '05.1 Cocoa and Chocolate products as covered by Directive 2000/36/EC.
- If tuna fish is the product for which ascorbic acid use levels are going to be reported, the restriction would be 'only tuna' falling in category '09.2 Processed fish and fishery products including molluscs and crustaceans'.
- If there are not restrictions/exceptions, then the option 'No restriction/exception to report' will need to be reported.

Example	XML
Only mozzarella (Food legislative category: 01.7.1 Unripened cheese excluding products falling in category 16)	<restrictionException>ADD00197A</restrictionException>
Only milk chocolate (Food legislative category: 05.1 Cocoa and Chocolate products as covered by Directive 2000/36/EC)	<restrictionException>ADD00386A</restrictionException>
Only tuna (Food legislative category: 09.2 Processed fish and fishery products including molluscs and crustaceans)	<restrictionException>ADD00622A</restrictionException>
No restriction/exception to report	<restrictionException>ADD00881A</restrictionException>

2.10 Brand name (brandName) (optional)

This optional data element, if information is available, can be provided for every record in the dataset. It is used to indicate the brand name of the reported product category/food.

2.11 Manufacturer name (manufacturer) (optional)

This optional data element, if information is available, can be provided for every record in the dataset. It is used to indicate the company manufacturer of the reported product category/food.

2.12 Manufacturer type (foodIndustry) (mandatory)

This data element must be provided for every record in the dataset. If this data element is equal to 'Yes', it indicates that the manufacturer is a food industry, 'No' indicates a 'food additive/flavouring producer'. The codes to be used are those from the YESNO catalogue.

Example	XML
Food industry Manufacturer	<foodIndustry>Y</ foodIndustry >

2.13 Parameter code (paramCode) (mandatory)

This data element specifies the code of the substance reported. The selected code must be present in the 'addAnalysis' (Food additives domain) or 'flavAnalysis' (Food flavourings domain) hierarchies, otherwise the data cannot be transmitted. In case more than one substance is going to be reported for a product category/food, the additional substance should be reported by creating a new record (row in the excel template) using the same prodId (see 2.2) while a different recId (see 2.15).

Example	XML
paramCode for Acetic Acid	<paramCode>RF-00000019-ADD</paramCode>
paramCode for 1-butanol	<paramCode>RF-00004837-PAR</paramCode>



2.14 Parameter text (paramText) (optional)

This data element is used to specify the name of the FA/FF for which the paramCode was reported. By default, if not present, it will be automatically populated by EFSA with the name of the paramCode reported.

2.15 Record identification code (recId) (mandatory)

This data element must be provided for every record in the dataset. It must be unique across all data collections from the very same DP. This identifier is used also for communication between EFSA and the DP during the transmission and validation phases. When validating data, it is essential to be able to detect the records counted and to identify those that may need to be amended.

It is recommended that certain prefixes or suffixes are included to ensure the recId is unique within a particular DP.

Example	XML
Record for food additives reported by a Finnish authority in 2026	<recId>FI_FALab2026_0006754</recId>

2.16 Widely consumed product (widelyConsumed) (optional)

This optional data element can be used to report whether the product is a 'Widely consumed' or a 'Niche' product, by a 'Yes' or 'No' answer. Only codes from the YESNO catalogue are allowed. 'Y' should be used for widely consumed products while 'N' otherwise.

Widely consumed products mean that they are representative of the product category/food, whereas niche product refers to products used by a specific population group (e.g., infant and follow-on formula, processed-cereal based baby food, food intended for sportspeople, gluten-free products, and food for special medical purposes), and foods which are consumed by few people, such as a regional product.

2.17 Presence/Added (presenceAdded) (mandatory)

This data element indicates whether the FA/FF is present and/or added in the reported product. The use of a FA in a food product should be indicated by law on the label, except for FA without technological role in the final product e.g., carriers (Article 20 Regulation 1169/2011⁶) and FA with nutritional purpose (Regulation 1925/2006⁷); for FF there is no legal requirement on labelling.

⁶ Regulation (EU) No 1169/2011 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 25 October 2011 on the provision of food information to consumers, amending Regulations (EC) No 1924/2006 and (EC) No 1925/2006 of the European Parliament and of the Council, and repealing Commission Directive 87/250/EEC, Council Directive 90/496/EEC, Commission Directive 1999/10/EC, Directive 2000/13/EC of the European Parliament and of the Council, Commission Directives 2002/67/EC and 2008/5/EC and Commission Regulation (EC) No 608/2004

⁷ Regulation (EC) No 1925/2006 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 20 December 2006 on the addition of vitamins and minerals and of certain other substances to foods

The codes to be used are those from the CONCLUS catalogue selecting the faff hierarchy. The two main options to be used are C19A ('Yes, present on label/added') and C20A ('No, not present on label/not added'). A third option, 'Natural occurrence' (C05A), can also be used in those cases in which the substance is in the product category/food as part of the matrix itself. As an example, C05A could be reported in combination with code C20A (C20A\$C05A) if the substance is not listed on the label/added but it occurs naturally.

The collection of these data might be used to refine dietary exposure estimations to FA/FF. If the information reported under this data element is 'No, not present on label/not added', this might be used as evidence that for a particular food within a food category a FA/FF was not used.

For FA/FF the following options can be provided:

- If the FA/FF is reported on the label or there is evidence of its use, 'Yes, present on label/added'.
- If the FA/FF is not reported on the label or there is evidence of not being used, 'No, not present on label/not added'. Once the DP fill in this data element as 'No, not present on label/not added', the use levels elements (minimum, typical and maximum) should be filled out with the value 0 (see also section 2.24, 2.25, and 2.26).
- If the FA/FF is not reported on the label or there is evidence of not being use, but it is naturally in the product category/food, 'No, not present on label/not added' \$ 'Natural occurrence'.
- If the FA/FF is reported on the label or there is evidence of its use, and it is naturally part of the product category/food, 'Yes, present on label/added' \$ 'Natural occurrence'.
- If the FA is not reported on the label but it has been added for other purposes, 'Yes, present on label/added'. In this case, DP must specify the FA function using the functionOf data element (see section 2.18).

Excel examples:

Example	presenceAdded	typicalLevel	maxLevel	functionOf
Food additive present on the label and added to the food as preservative	C19A (Yes, present on label/added)	100	100	pre (preservatives)
Food additive, not present on the label, but added to the food as nutrient	C19A (Yes, present on label/added)	20	20	nut (nutrient)
Food flavouring, not present on the label, but added to the food product	C19A (Yes, present on label/added)	20	20	-

Food flavouring, not present on the label but added to the reported product, while some part could come naturally	C19A\$C05A (Yes, present on label/added) + (Natural occurrence)	20	20	-
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XML examples:

Example	XML
Food additive present on the label and added to the food as preservative	<pre><presenceAdded>C19A</ presenceAdded > <typicalLevel>100</ typicalLevel> <maxLevel>100</ maxLevel> <functionOf>pre</ functionOf></pre>
Food additive, not present on the label while added to the food as nutrient	<pre><presenceAdded>C19A</ presenceAdded > <typicalLevel>20</ typicalLevel> <maxLevel>20</ maxLevel> <functionOf>nut</ functionOf></pre>
Food flavouring, not present on the label but added to the reported product	<pre><presenceAdded>C19A</ presenceAdded > <typicalLevel>20</ typicalLevel> <maxLevel>20</ maxLevel> <functionOf> </ functionOf></pre>
Food flavouring, not present on the label but added to the reported product, while some part could come naturally	<pre><presenceAdded> C19A\$C05A </ presenceAdded > <typicalLevel>20</ typicalLevel> <maxLevel>20</ maxLevel> <functionOf> </ functionOf></pre>

2.18 Function of the substance (functionOf) (dependent mandatory)

This dependent mandatory data element is used to indicate the functional class of the FA and, therefore, is required only for the food additives domain. The allowed options are available from the FUNC catalogue, and those applicable for FA are listed in Table 2.

Example	XML
Food additive belonging to the emulsifiers group	<pre><functionOf>emu</ functionOf ></pre>

2.19 Expression of product (weight) (mandatory)

This mandatory data element is used to describe if the use levels provided are expressed in whole weight, dry matter or fat weight. The codes need to be selected from the EXPRES catalogue and the whole_dry_fat (WDFat) hierarchy.

2.20 Percentage of fat (fatPerc) (dependent mandatory)

This data element is dependent on the expression of product (weight) data element. If the expression of product is set to 'fat' then a number expressing the percentage of fat in the product must be inputted.

2.21 Percentage of moisture (moistPerc) (dependent mandatory)

This data element is dependent on the expression of product (weight) data element. If the expression of product is set to 'dry matter' then a number expressing the percentage of moisture in the product must be inputted.

2.22 Result unit (unit) (mandatory)

This data element indicates the units in which minLevel, typicalLevel and maxLevel are expressed. All three values must be expressed in the same unit. The codes to be used should belong to the UNIT catalogue, 'chemUnit' hierarchy.

2.23 Additional information (additionalInfo) (optional)

This data element is used to provide any additional information on the reported product.

2.24 Minimum use level (minLevel) (optional)

This data element indicates the minimum use level of the substance in the reported product category/food.

It is highly recommended to report the minimum use level in the product/category food as consumed.

In case the FA/FF is not reported on the label or there is evidence of not being used ('No, not present on label/not added' selected for the data element presenceAdded), the minimum use level must be 0.

2.25 Typical use level (typicalLevel) (mandatory)

This data element indicates the typical use level of the substance in the reported product category/food.

It is highly recommended to report the typical use level in the product/category food as consumed.

If the reported typical use level refers to actual/exact use level, minimum, typical and maximum use levels will be filled with the same value.

In case the FA/FF is not reported on the label or there is evidence of not being used ('No, not present on label/not added' selected for the data element presenceAdded), the typical use level must be 0.

2.26 Maximum use level (maxLevel) (mandatory)

This data element indicates the maximum use level of the substance in the reported product category/food.

It is highly recommended to report the maximum use level in the product/category food as consumed.

In case the FA/FF is not reported on the label or there is evidence of not being used ('No, not present on label/not added' selected for the data element presenceAdded), the maximum use level must be 0.

2.27 Conversion or dilution factor (conversionOrDilutionFactor) (dependent mandatory)

This data element is used to indicate the recommended conversion or dilution factor to prepare the product category/food as it is consumed.

This data element will be mandatory when the product category/food refers to food supplements and when the product category/food needs to be prepared before it is consumed (e.g., infant formula needs to be hydrated before it is consumed).

The conversion or dilution factor must be indicated with the value that needs to be applied to the minimum, typical and maximum values.

Example	minLevel	typicalLevel	maxLevel	conversionOrDilutionFactor
Infant formula must be diluted before consuming in a ratio of 1:4 (0.25)	100	100	100	0.25

2.28 Is maximum permitted level defined (maxPermittedLevelDefined) (mandatory)

In case the maximum level is defined by the reported regulation (maxPermittedLevelDefined='Y'), then the maximum permitted level should be reported. The codes to be used should belong to the YESNO catalogue. The only codes that can be used are 'Y' or 'N'.

2.29 Maximum permitted level (maxPermittedLevel) (dependent mandatory)

This data element is used to indicate the maximum permitted level for the combination of the amount of the substance added and the amount present from its natural occurrence in the matrix.



3 Methodologies

National food authorities, research institutions, academia, food business operators and other interested stakeholders can designate a list of experts for sending data to EFSA. Multiple experts from the same stakeholder can be nominated as a Data Provider (DP) and/or Data Validator (DV). The expert nominated as DP shall access the Data Collection Framework (DCF) with EFSA credentials for sending data. Once logged in to the DCF, the designated DP, will have access to the folder to transmit at least one data file.

As regarding **data preparation**, each DP shall compile and report data to EFSA using the Excel reporting tool for use levels ([10.5281/zenodo.14893177](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.14893177)). Once the reporting tool has been completed with the relevant information, as described in the previous paragraphs, the file shall be exported in XML format.

For **data submission**, the XML file need to be uploaded in the EFSA DCF platform (<https://dcf.efsa.europa.eu/dcf-war/dc>) using the 'Insert New Dataset' button. Once the dataset has been assigned with a dataset Id and the 'processing' is finalised, the status of the dataset will be shown as:

- Rejected: dataset does not comply with the schema or wrong format.
- Rejected editable: dataset triggers BRs that are errors (Table 3).
- Valid with warnings: dataset triggers BRs that are warnings (Table 3).
- Valid: no BRs are triggered.

In case of status 'Rejected', 'Rejected editable' and 'Valid with warnings', DP can select the 'Ack view' button that provides information on the dataset and a summary of errors/warnings are presented at the end. If more detailed information is needed, the 'Ack details' button should be used.

After all identified errors have been addressed, the file can be newly uploaded to DCF replacing the existing dataset with the new data file by selecting 'Replace'.

Only datasets in status 'Valid' or 'Valid with warnings' can be submitted to the EFSA scientific DataWareHouse (sDWH). Each DP shall submit these datasets to make them available in the sDWH.

The final step consists of **data validation** in [MicroStrategy platform](#). All submitted data will be visible to specific validation dashboards, one day after submitting the dataset in DCF. DV can accept or reject the data in the Confirmation document, by selecting the final status of the datasets, 'Accepted' or 'Rejected', from the drop-down menu 'Confirm-Reject', in correspondence with the relative dataset ID. Once the DVs are satisfied with the accuracy and completeness of the datasets, they will be able to 'Accept' the data to ensure that data are in the EFSA sDWH and ready for use. At the end of the process, the DV must submit the final status of the datasets by clicking the 'Submit' button.

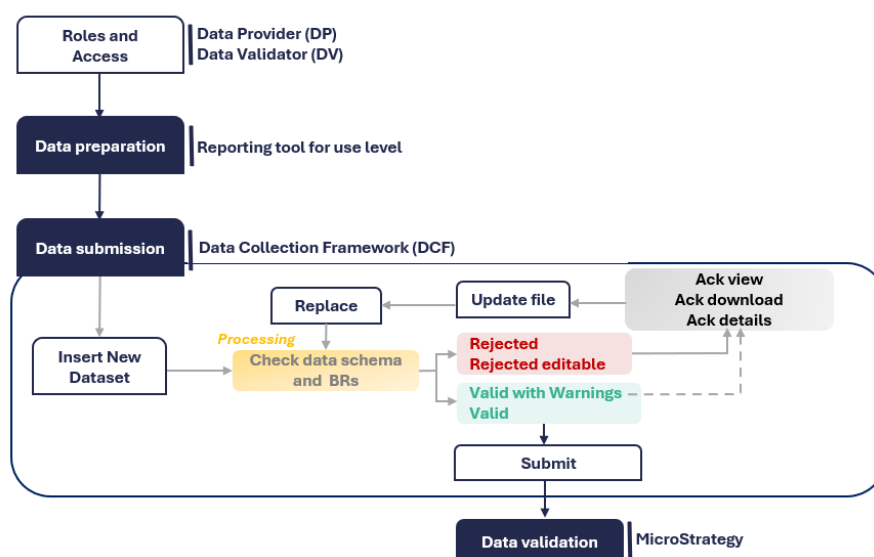


Figure 1. Data flow on the preparation, submission, validation and acceptance of the data

4 Legal Limit Database

EFSA developed a Legal Limit Database (LLDB) for FA/FF containing the Maximum Permitted Levels (MPLs) established in Regulation (EC) No 1333/2008 and Regulation (EC) No 1334/2008. This tool will be used for checking the compliance of the food product at result level versus what is authorised in the respective regulations at the marketing date of the product (Section 2.5).

Guidance for reporting use levels on food additives and food flavourings - 2026

Table 1: List of the data elements of the use levels model for the annual collection of FA/FF

Element label	Element name	Type	Controlled terminology	Mandatory/Optional	Notes	Business rule code
Programme legal reference	progLegalRef	xs:string (5)	LEGREF	Mandatory	Only codes from the LEGREF.faff hierarchy can be reported.	USE21 USE22
Product identification code	prodId	xs:string (100)		Mandatory	Unique identifier of the category reported.	USE01 USE20
Reporting country	repCountry	xs:string (2)	COUNTRY	Optional		
Marketing country	marketCountry	xs:repeatable	COUNTRY	Mandatory	List of countries in which the food is sold.	
Marketing year	marketYear	xs:integer (4)		Mandatory		USE01 USE26
Marketing month	marketMonth	xs:integer (2)		Mandatory		USE01 USE26
Marketing day	marketDay	xs:integer (2)		Mandatory		USE01 USE26
Reporting year	repYear	xs:integer (4)		Mandatory	Provide the reporting year, which needs to be equal to the current year of the data collection.	USE02
Coded description of the matrix	matCode	xs:compoundType	MTX	Mandatory	Description of the food item according to FoodEx2 (MTX) catalogue. F33, F23 and F03 facets must be included if not implicitly present in the term extended code, or when a more detailed facet needs to be specified: F33 in all cases, F23 when the product category/food belongs to the food legislative category 13 and F03 in some cases as specified in section 2.7.	USE03 USE16 USE17 USE23 USE24
Textual description of the matrix	matText	xs:string (400)		Optional		

Guidance for reporting use levels on food additives and food flavourings - 2026

Element label	Element name	Type	Controlled terminology	Mandatory/Optional	Notes	Business rule code
Restriction or exception	restrictionException	xs:string (9)	ADDFOOD	Mandatory	Only codes reportable under the FAREstExc/FFRestExc hierarchies can be reported respectively for the additive and flavouring domains.	USE04 USE05
Brand name	brandName	xs:string (250)		Optional		
Manufacturer name	manufacturer	xs:string (250)		Optional		
Manufacturer type	foodIndustry	xs:string (2)	YESNO	Mandatory	Only codes from the YESNO catalogue.	USE06
Parameter code	paramCode	xs:string (400)	PARAM	Mandatory	Only codes from the addAnalysis/flavAnalysis hierarchies can be reported.	USE07 USE20 USE21 USE22
Parameter text	paramText	xs:string (400)		Optional	Textual description of the parameter.	
Record identification code	recId	xs:string (100)		Mandatory	Unique identifier of each reported record.	
Widely consumed product	widelyConsumed	xs:string (2)	YESNO	Optional	This field can be used to report if the product is a 'Widely consumed' or 'Niche product'. Only codes from the YESNO catalogue.	USE08
Presence/Added	presenceAdded	xs:repeatable	CONCLUS	Mandatory	Textual declaration of the presence of the FA/FF on the product category/food. Only codes from the CONCLUS.faff hierarchy can be reported.	USE09 USE18 USE19
Function of the substance	functionOf	xs:repeatable	FUNC	Dependent mandatory	Describe the function of the food additive. It is mandatory only for the additive domain.	USE10
Expression of product	weight	xs:string (5)	EXPRRES	Mandatory	Only codes from the EXPRRES catalogue are allowed. Only codes from the EXPRRES.WDFat hierarchy can be reported.	
Percentage of fat	fatPerc	xs:double (6)		Dependent mandatory	Percentage of fat in which the result is expressed.	USE11

Guidance for reporting use levels on food additives and food flavourings - 2026

Element label	Element name	Type	Controlled terminology	Mandatory/Optional	Notes	Business rule code
Percentage of moisture	moistPerc	xs:double (6)		Dependent mandatory	Percentage of moisture in which the result is expressed.	USE12
Result unit	unit	xs:string (5)	UNIT	Mandatory	Only codes from the chemUnit hierarchy can be reported.	
Additional information	additionalInfo	xs:string (250)		Optional	Additional information on the reported product.	
Minimum use level	minLevel	xs:double		Optional		USE09 USE25
Typical use level	typicalLevel	xs:double		Mandatory		USE09 USE25
Maximum use level	maxLevel	xs:double		Mandatory		USE09 USE25
Conversion or dilution factor	conversionOrDilutionFactor	xs:double		Dependent mandatory	Complete to indicate the recommended conversion or dilution factor to be applied to food as it is consumed e.g. food supplements.	USE13
Is maximum permitted level defined	maxPermittedLevelDefined	xs:string (2)	YESNO	Mandatory	Indicate whether there is a maximum permitted level (MPL) defined in legislation or if added as Quantum satis. The codes to be used are 'Y' for defined MPL, 'N' otherwise.	USE14
Maximum permitted level	maxPermittedLevel	xs:integer (10)		Dependent mandatory	It is mandatory if maxPermittedLevelDefined='Y'.	USE15 USE27

Guidance for reporting use levels on food additives and food flavourings - 2026

Table 2: List of food additive classes

Food Additive class number	Food additive class name	Food additive class information
1	sweeteners	Substances used to impart a sweet taste to foods or in table-top sweeteners.
2	colours	Substances which add or restore colour in a food, and include natural constituents of foods and natural sources which are normally not consumed as foods as such and not normally used as characteristic ingredients of food. Preparations obtained from foods and other edible natural source materials obtained by physical and/or chemical extraction resulting in a selective extraction of the pigments relative to the nutritive or aromatic constituents are colours within the meaning of this Regulation.
3	preservatives	Substances which prolong the shelf-life of foods by protecting them against deterioration caused by micro-organisms and/or which protect against growth of pathogenic micro-organisms.
4	antioxidants	Substances which prolong the shelf-life of foods by protecting them against deterioration caused by oxidation, such as fat rancidity and colour changes.
5	carriers	Substances used to dissolve, dilute, disperse or otherwise physically modify a food additive or a flavouring, food enzyme, nutrient and/or other substance added for nutritional or physiological purposes to a food without altering its function (and without exerting any technological effect themselves) in order to facilitate its handling, application or use.
6	acids	Substances which increase the acidity of a foodstuff and/or impart a sour taste to it.
7	acidity regulators	Substances which alter or control the acidity or alkalinity of a foodstuff.
8	anti-caking agents	Substances which reduce the tendency of individual particles of a foodstuff to adhere to one another.
9	anti-foaming agents	Substances which prevent or reduce foaming.
10	bulking agents	Substances which contribute to the volume of a foodstuff without contributing significantly to its available energy value.
11	emulsifiers	Substances which make it possible to form or maintain a homogenous mixture of two or more immiscible phases such as oil and water in a foodstuff.
12	emulsifying salts	Substances which convert proteins contained in cheese into a dispersed form and thereby bring about homogenous distribution of fat and other components.
13	firming agents	Substances which make or keep tissues of fruit or vegetables firm or crisp, or interact with gelling agents to produce or strengthen a gel.
14	flavour enhancers	Substances which enhance the existing taste and/or odour of a foodstuff.
15	foaming agents	Substances which make it possible to form a homogenous dispersion of a gaseous phase in a liquid or solid foodstuff.
16	gelling agents	Substances which give a foodstuff texture through formation of a gel.
17	glazing agents (including lubricants)	Substances which, when applied to the external surface of a foodstuff, impart a shiny appearance or provide a protective coating.

Guidance for reporting use levels on food additives and food flavourings - 2026

Food Additive class number	Food additive class name	Food additive class information
18	humectants	Substances which prevent foods from drying out by counteracting the effect of an atmosphere having a low degree of humidity, or promote the dissolution of a powder in an aqueous medium.
19	modified starches	Substances obtained by one or more chemical treatments of edible starches, which may have undergone a physical or enzymatic treatment, and may be acid or alkali thinned or bleached.
20	packaging gases	Gases other than air, introduced into a container before, during or after the placing of a foodstuff in that container.
21	propellants	Gases other than air which expel a foodstuff from a container.
22	raising agents	Substances or combinations of substances which liberate gas and thereby increase the volume of a dough or a batter.
23	sequestrants	Substances which form chemical complexes with metallic ions.
24	stabilisers	Substances which make it possible to maintain the physico-chemical state of a foodstuff; stabilisers include substances which enable the maintenance of a homogenous dispersion of two or more immiscible substances in a foodstuff, substances which stabilise, retain or intensify an existing colour of a foodstuff and substances which increase the binding capacity of the food, including the formation of cross-links between proteins enabling the binding of food pieces into re-constituted food.
25	thickeners	Substances which increase the viscosity of a foodstuff.
26	flour treatment agents	Substances, other than emulsifiers, which are added to flour or dough to improve its baking quality.
27	contrast enhancers	Substances which, when applied to the external surface of fruit or vegetables following depigmentation of predefined parts (e.g. by laser treatment), help to distinguish these parts from the remaining surface by imparting colour following interaction with certain components of the epidermis.
28	nutrient	
29	Annex III – Carriers in food additives	
30	Annex III – Food additives other than carriers in food additives	
31	Annex III – Food additives including carriers in food enzymes	
32	Annex III - Food additives including carriers in food flavourings	
33	Annex III – Food additives in nutrients	

Guidance for reporting use levels on food additives and food flavourings - 2026

Table 3: List of the business rules applicable

Business rule code	Description	Error/Warning message	Type of error	Status
USE01	The combination of matCode, repCountry, marketCountry, brandName, manufacturer, foodIndustry, widelyConsumed, marketYear, marketMonth and marketDay must be constant for all the records with the same product id (prodId).	The combination of matCode, repCountry, marketCountry, brandName, manufacturer, foodIndustry, widelyConsumed, marketYear, marketMonth and marketDay is not the same for all the records with the same product id (prodId).	Error	Active
USE02	The reporting year (repYear) should be equal to the calendar year of the data collection.	The reporting year (repYear) is not equal to the calendar year of the data collection.	Error	Active
USE03	The target consumer facet (F23) must be reported under the coded description of the matrix (matCode) if the product category/food refers to the following food legislative category (matCode.F33): 13 – Foods intended for particular nutritional uses as defined by Directive 2009/39/EC.	The target consumer facet (F23) is not reported when the food legislative category is 13 – Foods intended for particular nutritional uses as defined by Directive 2009/39/EC.	Error	Active
USE04	If the programme legal reference is for FA (progLegalRef = N112A), the restriction/exception must be reported using the FARestExc hierarchy. If there are no restriction or exception to report, the option 'No restriction/exception to report' (ADD00881A) must be selected within the same hierarchy.	FA data is reported (progLegalRef = N112A), but either the field is empty, or data input is not reportable under FARestExc hierarchy. If no restriction/exception applies, then 'No restriction/exception to report' (ADD00881A) should be indicated.	Error	Active
USE05	If the programme legal reference is for FF (progLegalRef = N113A), the restriction/exception must be reported using the FFRestExc hierarchy. If there are no restriction or exception to report, the option 'No restriction/exception to report' (ADD00881A) must be selected within the same hierarchy.	FF data is reported (progLegalRef = N113A), but either the field is empty, or data input is not reportable under FFRestExc hierarchy. If no restriction/exception applies, then 'No restriction/exception to report' (ADD00881A) should be indicated.	Error	Active

Guidance for reporting use levels on food additives and food flavourings - 2026

USE06	The manufacturer type (foodIndustry) can only be 'Y' (Yes) if the producer is a food industry or 'N' (No) if the producer is the food additive/flavouring producer.	The manufacturer type (foodIndustry) is not in the allowed list of codes.	Error	Active
USE07	The coded description of parameter (paramCode) must belong to the food additives (addAnalysis) and/or food flavourings (flavAnalysis) hierarchy of the PARAM catalogue.	The coded description of parameter (paramCode) does not belong to the food additives (addAnalysis) and/or food flavourings (flavAnalysis) hierarchy of the PARAM catalogue.	Error	Active
USE08	The widely consumed data element (widelyConsumed) can only be 'Y' (Yes) for widely consumed products while 'N' (No) otherwise.	The widely consumed data element (widelyConsumed) is not in the allowed list of codes.	Error	Active
USE09	When no FA/FF are added (presenceAdded = 'No, not present on label/not added' (C20A)), the minimum, typical and maximum levels (minLevel, typicalLevel and maxLevel) must be 0.	presenceAdded is 'No, not present on label/not added' (C20A) but the minimum, typical or maximum levels (minLevel, typicalLevel and maxLevel) are not 0.	Error	Active
USE10	The function of the substance (functionOf) must be reported if the programme legal reference (progLegRef) is equal to the additive domain (N112A).	The function of the substance (functionOf) is missing, even though the programme legal reference (progLegRef) is equal to the additive domain (N112A).	Error	Active
USE11	The percentage of fat (fatPerc) must be reported if the expression of product (weight) is expressed as fat; i.e. weight = 'fat weight'.	The percentage of fat (fatPerc) is not reported even though the expression of product (weight) is expressed as 'fat weight'.	Error	Active
USE12	The percentage of moisture (moistPerc) must be reported if the expression of product (weight) is expressed as dry matter; i.e., weight = 'dry matter'.	The percentage of moisture (moistPerc) is not reported even though the expression of product (weight) is expressed as 'dry matter'.	Error	Active
USE13	The conversion/Dilution factor (conversionOrDilutionFactor) must be reported if the product category/food refers to the following food legislative category (matCode.F33): 17 – Food supplements as defined in Directive 2002/46/EC of the European Parliament and of the Council excluding food supplements for infants and young children.	The conversion/Dilution factor (conversionOrDilutionFactor) is not reported even though the product category/food refers to the food legislative category number (matCode:F33) 17.	Error	Active
USE14	The type of limit for the result evaluation (maxPermittedLevelDefined) should belong to the allowed list of code ('Y' or 'N') from the YESNO catalogue.	The type of limit for the result evaluation data element is not in the allowed list of codes.	Error	Active

Guidance for reporting use levels on food additives and food flavourings - 2026

USE15	The maximum permitted level (maxPermittedLevel) must be provided when the type of limit for the result evaluation (maxPermittedLevelDefined) is yes ('Y').	The maximum permitted level is missing even though the type of limit for the result evaluation (maxPermittedLevelDefined) is yes ('Y').	Error	Active
USE16	The food legislative classes facet (F33) of the product category/food must be reported under the coded description of the matrix (matCode) if it is not implicitly assigned. The physical state facet (F03) must be reported under the coded description of the matrix (matCode) if the product category/food refers to the following food legislative categories (matCode.F33):	The food legislative classes facet (F33) of the product category/food is null.	Error	Active
USE17	• 01.5 Dehydrated milk as defined by Directive 2001/114/EC • 01.6 Cream and cream powder • 01.8 Dairy analogues, including beverage whiteners • 01.9 Edible caseinates • 01.10 Milk-based drinks and similar products intended for young children • 06.3 Breakfast cereals • 12.5 Soups and broths • 12.6 Sauces • 13 Foods intended for specific groups as defined by Regulation (EU) No 609/2013 • 14.1.2 Fruit juices as defined by Directive 2001/112/EC and vegetable juices • 14.1.3 Fruit nectars as defined by Directive 2001/112/EC and vegetable nectars and similar products • 14.1.4 Flavoured drinks • 14.1.5 Coffee, coffee and chicory extracts, tea, herbal- and fruit-infusions; coffee substitutes, coffee mixes and mixes for 'hot beverages' • 17. Food supplements as defined in Directive 2002/46/EC of the European Parliament and of the Council excluding food supplements for infants and young children	The physical state facet (F03) of the product category/food is not reported for this specific food legislative category.	Error	Active

Guidance for reporting use levels on food additives and food flavourings - 2026

USE18	The reported values about presence and addition of FA/FF (presenceAdded) must be meaningful. "Yes, present on label/added" (C19A) and "No, not present on label/not added" (C20A) cannot be submitted in the same record.	The reported values in presenceAdded must be meaningful. "Yes, present on label/added" (C19A) and "No, not present on label/not added" (C20A) cannot be submitted in the same record.	Error	Active
USE19	If FA/FF are added (presenceAdded = 'Yes, present on label/added' (C19A)), the typical or the maximum level (typicalLevel or maxLevel) cannot be 0.	presenceAdded is 'Yes, present on label/added' (C10A) but nor the typical nor the maximum level (typicalLevel and maxLevel) is greater than 0.	Error	Active
USE20	The combination of parameter code (paramCode) and product identification code (prodId) needs to be unique.	The combination of parameter code (paramCode) and product identification code (prodId) is not unique.	Error	Active
USE21	If the progLegRef is N112A, then the substance reported (paramCode) must belong to the hierarchy addAnalysis.	The reported paramCode does not belong to the progLegRef N112A.	Error	Active
USE22	If the progLegRef is N113A, then the substance reported (paramCode) must belong to the hierarchy flavAnalysis.	The reported paramCode does not belong to the progLegRef N113A.	Error	Active
USE23	If the food legislative category (F33) contained in the matCode is implicit, then an explicit F33 cannot be reported.	The food legislative category (F33) is implicitly present in FoodEx2 base term.	Error	Active
USE24	The following codes "Food colours" 'A047N', "Artificial food colour" 'A047Q', "Food additives other than flavours, colours and artificial sweeteners" 'A047R', "Food flavourings" 'A047A', "Natural food colour" 'A047P' and "Preparations for food flavouring" 'A0F3T' cannot be reported as matCode.	The matCode is not in the allowed list of codes.	Error	Active
USE25	The maxLevel must be equal or greater than the typicalLevel which must be equal or greater than the minLevel.	The maxLevel must be equal or greater than the typicalLevel and minLevel.	Error	Active
USE26	The combination of values in marketDay, marketMonth and marketYear must be a valid date.	The combination of values in marketDay, marketMonth and marketYear is not a valid date.	Error	Active

Guidance for reporting use levels on food additives and food flavourings - 2026

USE27	The maximum use level is greater than the MPL reported by the Data Provider.	The maximum use level should be equal or lower than the MPL.	Error	Active
USE_LLDB01	The substance (paramCode) reported should be authorised in this legislative category with this restriction/exception according to Regulation 1333/2008 and 1334/2008.	The paramCode is not authorised in this legislative category with this restriction/exception according to Regulation 1333/2008 and 1334/2008.	Error	Active
USE_LLDB02	The maximum use level should be equal or lower than the MPL.	The maximum use level is greater than the MPL from LLDB.	Error	Active

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Abbreviations

BR	Business Rules
ChemMon	EFSA Chemical Monitoring data collection
DCF	Data Collection Framework
DM	Data Model
DP	Data Provider
DV	Data Validator
EC	European Commission
EFSA	European Food Safety Authority
FA	Food Additive
FF	Food Flavouring
LLDB	Legal Limit Database
MPL	Maximum Permitted Level
MS	EU Member States
sDWH	EFSA scientific DataWareHouse
SSD1	EFSA Standard Sample Description (ver.1)
SSD2	EFSA Standard Sample Description (ver.2)
XML	Extensible Markup Language